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Clamshell packaging container

Abstract

Clamshell packaging containers and methods of making them are disclosed. A container includes a first shell portion and a complementary second shell portion that defines a product cavity. A bridging portion coupled to the first shell portion at a first hinge and the second shell portion at a second hinge such that the bridging portion is pivotable relative to each of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in a disassembled configuration, and is pivotable relative to one of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in an assembled configuration.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to packaging and methods of packaging consumer goods such as comestibles.

BACKGROUND

(2) Consumer goods are often disposed in any of a variety of package types to organize, display, and protect products. Rigid packaging provides several advantages over other forms of packages such as increased protection of product housed within, improved reusability and durability, and strong potential for attractive branding and designs.

(3) A common form of rigid packaging is a clamshell container, where two complementary container portions are coupled together at a hinge. As such, the container can be opened and closed to access and secure contents housed within. Sturdy construction and reliable opening and closing movements are desirable characteristics for clamshell containers.

(4) Clamshell containers can be manufactured through various molding and casting processes, for example injection molding. However, a challenge that can occur when using molds to create clamshell containers is known in the packaging arts as a “thin steel condition,” where the thinness of one or more portions of a given mold gives rise to several manufacturing issues with respect to warping, temperature management, maintenance difficulties, and poor lifespan of the mold. This is a particularly prominent issue with respect to molding hinge or coupling portions between container portions.

(5) In addition, rigid clamshell containers are often bulky with relatively narrow branding surfaces that only provide limited visibility when presented among competing products on shelf and can be inconvenient for consumers to carry. As such, there is also a need for rigid containers with a stronger presence on shelf with broader branding space while being shaped for convenient transport by consumers.

SUMMARY

(6) One embodiment relates to a container. The container includes a first shell portion and a second shell portion sized and shaped to complement the first shell portion to define a product cavity. The container further includes a bridging portion coupled to the first shell portion at a first hinge and the second shell portion at a second hinge, wherein the bridging portion is pivotable relative to each of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in a disassembled configuration and the bridging portion is pivotable relative to one of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in an assembled configuration.

(7) Another embodiment relates to a method of manufacturing a container. The method includes providing a mold shaped to define a first shell portion, a second shell portion sized and shaped to complement the first shell portion to define a product cavity, and a bridging portion coupled to the first shell portion at a first hinge and the second shell portion at a second hinge, wherein the bridging portion is pivotable relative to each of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in a disassembled configuration and the bridging portion is pivotable relative to one of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in an assembled configuration. The method further includes forming the container using the mold. The method also includes coupling permanently the bridging portion to one of the first shell portion and the second shell portion.

(8) It should be appreciated that all combinations of the foregoing concepts and additional concepts discussed in greater detail below (provided such concepts are not mutually inconsistent) are contemplated as being part of the inventive subject matter disclosed herein. All combinations of claimed subject matter appearing at the end of this disclosure are contemplated as being part of the inventive subject matter disclosed herein.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) A skilled artisan will understand that the drawings primarily are for illustrative purposes and are not intended to limit the scope of the subject matter described herein. The drawings are not necessarily to scale; in some instances, various aspects of the subject matter disclosed herein may be shown exaggerated or enlarged in the drawings to facilitate an understanding of different features. In the drawings, like reference characters generally refer to like features (e.g., functionally similar and/or structurally similar elements).

(2) FIG. 1A is a perspective view of a clamshell package in an unassembled, open configuration, according to an example embodiment.

(3) FIG. 1B is a left side view of the clamshell package of FIG. 1A in the unassembled, open configuration, according to an example embodiment.

(4) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a clamshell package in an unassembled, open configuration with a second portion shown as transparent, according to an alternative embodiment.

(5) FIG. 3A is a perspective view of the clamshell package of FIG. 1A in an assembled, open configuration, according to an example embodiment.

(6) FIG. 3B is a left side view of the clamshell package of FIG. 3A in the assembled, open configuration, according to an example embodiment.

(7) FIG. 4 is a left side view of the clamshell package of FIG. 1A in an assembled, closed configuration, according to an example embodiment.

(8) FIG. 5 illustrates a flow diagram showing a method of making a rigid clamshell container, according to an example embodiment.

(9) The features and advantages of the inventive concepts disclosed herein will become more apparent from the detailed description set forth below when taken in conjunction with the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) Following below are more detailed descriptions of various concepts related to, and embodiments of, inventive rigid clamshell containers and methods of making such containers. It should be appreciated that various concepts introduced above and discussed in greater detail below may be implemented in any of numerous ways, as the disclosed concepts are not limited to any particular manner of implementation. Examples of specific implementations and applications are provided primarily for illustrative purposes.

(11) Referring to FIGS. 1A and 1B, a container **100** is shown in an open, unassembled configuration in accordance with example embodiments. In the arrangement shown, the container **100** is overall rectangularly shaped with rounded corners in a closed configuration, and openable to complementary halves in an open configuration. Other sizes and shapes of the container **100** are contemplated by and usable for the concepts provided in this disclosure, such as round shapes, oval shapes, square shapes, irregular, symmetrical, or asymmetrical shapes, and so on. In addition, as discussed below, the container **100** may or may not be disposed in equal sized halves in the open configuration. The container **100** may be used to house and protect consumer packaged goods such as food items, including but not limited to chewing gum. The container **100** may be made from any of a variety of materials used in the packaging arts, and in particular may be made of materials used in molding or casting processes that ultimately give rise to rigid packages, such as plastics, metals, or alloys or a combination thereof. In some arrangements, the container **100** is formed from materials derived from natural sources or may be made from biodegradable, compostable, recyclable, or otherwise sustainable materials.

(12) The container **100** is configured as a clamshell and includes a first shell portion **102** configured to complementarily and releasably engage a second shell portion **104**. Either or both of the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104** may be formed such that the container **100** defines a product cavity that is sized and configured to fit a product **107** within the container **100** while in the closed configuration. In some arrangements, one shell portion may be formed as a lid while product **107** is primarily housed in the other shell portion. In other arrangements, each shell portion may be formed to house product **107**, even when the container **100** is in the open configuration.

(13) The product **107** may be any of a variety of items sold as consumer-packaged goods, as described above. In the arrangement shown, the product **107** is embodied as a plurality of chewing gum sticks in a side-by-side arrangement of gum stacks. In various arrangements, each stack of gum may be secured together by an article organizing member **124** such as a belly band, and in turn the stacks of gum may be further secured in the side-by-side arrangement by an article stack organizing member **126** such as a sheath, a larger belly band, and so on to attractively maintain the organization of gum sticks as individual gum sticks are removed. In some such arrangements, a given article organizing member **124** or the article stack organizing member **126** may be secured to the first shell portion **102** or the second shell portion **104**, for example with adhesive, clips, tabs, and so on. This side-by-side arrangement of the product **107** provides the benefit of large surfaces for branding, designs, text, and other eye-catching visual features on the container **100** that significantly improves its presences on a display shelf. In addition, the side-by-side arrangement of product **107** provides a slim profile of the container **100** despite housing larger amounts of the product **107**.

(14) In the arrangement shown, the product **107** is disposed in both the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104** when the container **100** is in the open configuration. In some such arrangements, different types or varieties of the product **107** may be separately housed in the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104**, for example different flavors of comestible products may be arranged in each shell portion. However, in other arrangements, the product **107** may be disposed in either the first shell portion **102** only or the second shell portion **104** only when the container **100** is in the open configuration. In the arrangement shown in FIG. 2, the product **107** is housed in only the second shell portion **104** while the container **100** is in the open configuration, and further includes a stadium member **122** such as a shelf configured to stagger an arrangement the product **107**, for example such that the product **107** is attractively displayed at different heights. In arrangements as that shown here where the product **107** is a plurality of articles, the stadium member **122** staggers the height of some of the articles relative to other articles such that multiple rows of the product **107** are shown at different heights. As one skilled in the art would appreciate, the stadium member **122** may be present in both shell portions **102**, **104** in embodiments where the product **107** is disposed in both shell portions **102**, **104**.

(15) Returning to FIGS. 1A and 1B, in some arrangements, the container **100** includes a securing member that releasably couples the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104** together such that in a closed configuration product is safely housed in the product chamber, and in an open configuration the product is accessible to a user. Such features may be embodied as one or more undercuts, tabs and slots, ribs, interlocking protrusions, or other complementary components configured for releasable engagement. In the arrangement shown, the securing member is embodied as a first set of ribs **114** and a complementary second set of ribs **116** disposed on the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104** respectively. In this arrangement, the first set of ribs **114** is disposed on internal faces of an internally facing recessed lip at the rim of either lateral side of the first shell portion **102**, and the second set of ribs **116** is disposed on exterior faces of an exterior facing recessed lip at the rim of either lateral side of the second shell portion **104**. The recessed lips on the shell portions **102**, **104** are configured to complement and engage each other when the container **100** is in the closed configuration. In the arrangement shown, the ribs of the sets of ribs **114**, **116** are disposed parallel to the rim of each respective shell portion **102**, **104**. In operation, as the container **100** is transitioned from the open configuration to the closed configuration, the first set of ribs **114** interlocks with the second set of ribs **116** as the first shell portion **102** engages the second shell portion **104**, thereby releasably securing the container in the closed configuration. In some arrangements, the securing member is configured for audible engagement such as a pleasing “click” or other sound when the first shell portion **102** is secured to the second shell portion **104**. For example, the first set of ribs **114** and the second set of ribs **116** may be configured to “click” when the ribs interlock in the closed configuration.

(16) In some arrangements, the container **100** may include either or both of a first branding area **118** and a second branding area **120** disposed on interior faces (i.e., facing into the product cavity) of the first shell portion **102** or the second shell portion **104** respectively. The first branding area **118** and the second branding area **120** are portions of these interior faces upon which graphics, logos, decorations, slogans, or other visual components are disposed, for example as stickers, prints, dye, paint, embossed or debossed digits or designs, etched digits or designs, and so on. In some such arrangements like the arrangement shown in FIG. 1, at least a portion of the first branding area **118** and the second branding area **120** is visible even while the product **107** is disposed in the container **100**. In other arrangements, either or both of the first branding area **118** and the second branding area **120** become visible as or after product **107** is removed from the container **100**.

(17) In some arrangements, the branding areas **118**, **120** as well as the exterior faces of the container **100** may be used for any of a variety of highly customizable branding, personalization, or messaging purposes. Each of these areas and faces may be customized independently of any

molding or casting processes used to make the container **100** itself, and as a result, the same stockpile of containers **100** may be used for different products, different brands, different varieties of product, and even for specific customers, by simply customizing the branding areas **118**, **120** or exterior faces of each container **100**. For example, in an embodiment, the exterior faces of a given container **100** present the logos, colors, and branding of a specific brand of chewing gum as determined by the chewing gum manufacturer, while the first branding area **118** and the second branding area **120** include images and text customized for a specific user. Any combination of such branding, personalization, and messaging across the exterior faces of the container **100** and the branding areas **118**, **120** are contemplated by this disclosure.

(18) In yet more arrangements, the container **100** may be formed such that it is entirely or partially transparent, so that one or more components inside are visible even when the container **100** is closed. As such, various components inside the container **100** may be used as branding surfaces. For example, in one such arrangement, the article stack organizing member **126** may include visual elements (e.g., any such elements that may be disposed on a branding area **118**, **120**) disposed on externally facing surfaces that would be visible through a transparent embodiment of the container **100**. Visual elements may similarly be applied to the article organizing member **124** or individual wrappers of the product **107**.

(19) A bridging portion **106** is disposed between the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104**. A first hinge **108** and a second hinge **110** couples opposing ends of the bridging portion **106** to the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104** of the container respectively. Each hinge **108**, **110** is a component capable of enabling a pivoting or hinging movement, such as a living hinge, a line of weakening, and so on. As a result, each of the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104** can pivot relative to the bridging portion **106**. The bridging portion **106** is sized and shaped to be received by either of the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104** when the container **100** is in an assembled configuration (e.g., as shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B). In the arrangement shown in the figures, the bridging portion **106** spans less than the full width of the second shell portion **104**, and the second shell portion **104** has a cutout sized and shaped to receive the bridging portion **106**. In other arrangements, the bridging portion **106** may be received by either or both of the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104**.

(20) As may be appreciated particularly in FIG. 1B, the bridging portion **106** effectively increases the distance between the first clamshell portion **102** and the second clamshell portion **104** when the container is molded in the unassembled configuration. As a result, a larger mold segment can be disposed between the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104**, thereby substantially reducing or eliminating thin steel conditions when the container is being manufactured.

(21) Turning to FIGS. 3A and 3B, the container **100** is shown in an assembled, open configuration. The container **100** includes one or more fasteners **112** that permanently couple the bridging portion **106** to either of the first shell portion **102** or the second shell portion **104**. The fasteners **112** couple the bridging portion **106** to the second shell portion **104** in the embodiment shown in FIGS. 3A and 3B. In contrast to the securing member, the coupling function of the fasteners **112** are not releasable, and as such, once the bridging portion **106** is coupled to one of the shell portions **102**, **104**, it cannot be readily uncoupled without a significant application of force or damaging the fasteners **112** or the corresponding shell or bridging portions **102**, **104**, **106**. In various arrangements, the fasteners **112** may be embodied as one-way (i.e., irreversible) tabs or ribs, adhesives, welded or fused portions of the container, or other mechanical components intended for permanent engagement. As such, once the bridging portion **106** is coupled to a shell portion **102**, **104**, decoupling the bridging portion **106** would result in deforming tabs or ribs, or tearing adhesives or welds, and so on depending on the manner of fastener **112** used. In the arrangement of FIGS. 3A and 3B, the fasteners **112** are embodied as laterally protruding tabs on opposing sides of the bridging portion **106** that clip to the second shell portion **104** as the second shell portion **104**

receives the bridging portion **106**. In other arrangements using laterally protruding tabs, the fasteners **112** may be disposed on the first or second shell portion **102**, **104** and clip onto the bridging portion **106**.

(22) The container **100** is shown in an assembled, closed configuration in FIG. **4**. As a result of the bridging portion **106** being permanently coupled to the second shell portion **104**, the first shell portion **102** can only pivot relative to the second shell portion **104** at the first hinge **108** to open and close the container **100**. In arrangements where the bridging component **106** is instead permanently coupled to the first shell portion **102**, the first shell portion can only pivot relative to the second shell portion **104** at the second hinge **110**.

(23) The advantage provided by taking the extra step of permanently coupling the bridging portion **106** to either of the first shell portion **102** and the second shell portion **104** after the container **100** is created is that the reduction or elimination of thin steel conditions in manufacturing is preserved while providing a single piece clamshell container (i.e., where the container is molded as a single piece not requiring the coupling together of separate pieces) with a strong, tightened pivoting action for opening and closing at a single hinge. In addition, the overall profile of the container **100** while in the open configuration is slimmer and more attractive, for example as shown in FIG. **3B**. Maintaining a wider hinge for example by not permanently coupling the bridging portion **106** to one of the first shell portion **102** and second shell portion, or having a larger hinge altogether results in a weaker, flimsy hinge that disposes the first shell portion **102** at a greater distance from the second shell portion **104** when the container **100** is in the open configuration, for example as shown in FIG. **1B**. As such, the costs of taking the additional step of permanently coupling the bridging portion **106** to a shell portion **102**, **104** that renders one of the hinges **108**, **110** inoperable are well justified by the advantages both in manufacturing and consumer use.

(24) In operation, an end user receives the container **100** housing product **107** in the closed configuration shown in FIG. **4**. When the user wishes to access the product **107**, the first shell portion **102** is urged away from the second shell portion **104**, causing a pivoting action at the first hinge **108** when resistance provided by the interlocked first set of ribs **114** and second set of ribs **116** is overcome. The container **100** is then transitioned to the open configuration shown in FIG. **3**, exposing the product **107** held within. The user selects one of the product **107** and observes the first branding area **118** and the second branding area **120** before returning the container **100** to the closed configuration as shown in FIG. **5**. Throughout this operation, the bridging component **106** remains coupled to the second shell portion **104**.

(25) FIG. **5** illustrates a flow diagram showing a method **500** of making a clamshell container (e.g., container **100**) containing consumer packaged goods (e.g., product **107**) in accordance with example embodiments.

(26) At **502**, a container mold is provided. The container mold is shaped to define the container and includes a first shell portion (e.g., the first shell portion **102**), a second shell portion (e.g., the second shell portion **104**), and a bridging portion (e.g., the bridging portion **106**). In various arrangements, the container mold may further define fasteners (e.g., fasteners **112**), securing members (e.g., the first set of ribs **114** and the second set of ribs **116**), stadium members (e.g., the stadium member **122**).

(27) At **504**, a container (e.g., the container **100**) is formed. The container is formed using the mold provided at **502** and may be made by any of various known processes such as injection molding or casting.

(28) In some arrangements, branding areas (e.g., branding areas **118**, **120**) are applied to either or both of the first shell portion and the second shell portion of the container at **506**. Branding areas may be applied by way of prints, dyes, stickers, or any of a variety of visual application methods.

(29) At **508**, the container is filled with product (e.g., the product **107**). The product may be disposed at either or both of the first shell portion and the second shell portion of the container.

(30) At **510**, the bridging portion is coupled to either or both of the first shell portion and the

second shell portion of the container. Fasteners (e.g., fasteners **112**) are used to permanently couple the bridging portion to at least one of the first shell portion and the second shell portion of the container.

(31) At **512**, the container is moved to a closed configuration (e.g., as shown in FIG. **4**). The first shell portion is pivoted at a hinge (e.g., the first hinge **108**) of the bridging portion to releasably engage the second shell portion to arrive at the closed configuration. In some arrangements, additional graphics are disposed on exterior faces of the container (e.g., stickers, prints, dyes, etc.) and an overwrap is applied. Further, in some such arrangements, yet more graphics are applied on top of the overwrap (e.g., stickers, prints, etc.).

(32) For the purpose of this disclosure, the term(s) “coupled” means the joining of two members directly or indirectly to one another. Such joining may be stationary or moveable in nature. Such joining may be achieved with the two members or the two members and any additional intermediate members being integrally formed as a single unitary body with one another or with the two members or the two members and any additional intermediate members being attached to one another. Such joining may be permanent in nature or may be removable or releasable in nature.

(33) It should be noted that the orientation of various elements may differ according to other exemplary embodiments, and that such variations are intended to be encompassed by the present disclosure. It is recognized that features of the disclosed embodiments can be incorporated into other disclosed embodiments.

(34) It is important to note that the constructions and arrangements of apparatuses or the components thereof as shown in the various exemplary embodiments are illustrative only. Although only a few embodiments have been described in detail in this disclosure, those skilled in the art who review this disclosure will readily appreciate that many modifications are possible (e.g., variations in sizes, dimensions, structures, shapes and proportions of the various elements, values of parameters, mounting arrangements, use of materials, colors, orientations, etc.) without materially departing from the novel teachings and advantages of the subject matter disclosed. For example, elements shown as integrally formed may be constructed of multiple parts or elements, the position of elements may be reversed or otherwise varied, and the nature or number of discrete elements or positions may be altered or varied. The order or sequence of any process or method steps may be varied or re-sequenced according to alternative embodiments. Other substitutions, modifications, changes and omissions may also be made in the design, operating conditions and arrangement of the various exemplary embodiments without departing from the scope of the present disclosure.

(35) While various inventive embodiments have been described and illustrated herein, those of ordinary skill in the art will readily envision a variety of other mechanisms and/or structures for performing the function and/or obtaining the results and/or one or more of the advantages described herein, and each of such variations and/or modifications is deemed to be within the scope of the inventive embodiments described herein. More generally, those skilled in the art will readily appreciate that, unless otherwise noted, any parameters, dimensions, materials, and configurations described herein are meant to be exemplary and that the actual parameters, dimensions, materials, and/or configurations will depend upon the specific application or applications for which the inventive teachings is/are used. Those skilled in the art will recognize or be able to ascertain using no more than routine experimentation, many equivalents to the specific inventive embodiments described herein. It is, therefore, to be understood that the foregoing embodiments are presented by way of example only and that, within the scope of the appended claims and equivalents thereto, inventive embodiments may be practiced otherwise than as specifically described and claimed. Inventive embodiments of the present disclosure are directed to each individual feature, system, article, material, kit, and/or method described herein. In addition, any combination of two or more such features, systems, articles, materials, kits, and/or methods, if such features, systems, articles, materials, kits, and/or methods are not mutually inconsistent, is included within the inventive scope

of the present disclosure.

(36) Also, the technology described herein may be embodied as a method, of which at least one example has been provided. The acts performed as part of the method may be ordered in any suitable way unless otherwise specifically noted. Accordingly, embodiments may be constructed in which acts are performed in an order different than illustrated, which may include performing some acts simultaneously, even though shown as sequential acts in illustrative embodiments.

(37) The claims should not be read as limited to the described order or elements unless stated to that effect. Various changes in form and detail may be made by one of ordinary skill in the art without departing from the spirit and scope of the appended claims. All embodiments that come within the spirit and scope of the following claims and equivalents thereto are claimed.

Claims

1. A container comprising: a first shell portion; a second shell portion sized and shaped to complement the first shell portion to define a product cavity; a bridging portion coupled to the first shell portion at a first hinge and the second shell portion at a second hinge, wherein the bridging portion is pivotable relative to each of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in a disassembled configuration and the bridging portion is pivotable relative to only one of the first shell portion at the first hinge or the second shell portion at the second hinge in an assembled configuration; and a fastener coupled to the bridging portion and to one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion in the assembled configuration, wherein the fastener prevents the bridging portion from pivoting relative to the one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion in the assembled configuration.
2. The container of claim 1 wherein one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion is sized and shaped to house a product when the container is in an open configuration.
3. The container of claim 1 wherein each of the first shell portion and the second shell portion is sized and shaped to house a product when the container is in an open configuration.
4. The container of claim 1, further comprising a product comprising a plurality of articles and at least one stadium member shaped to stagger an arrangement of the plurality of articles in the container.
5. The container of claim 1, further comprising a product comprising a plurality of articles wherein the plurality of articles is organized as a side-by-side arrangement of stacks.
6. The container of claim 5 wherein the product is coupled to the container.
7. The container of claim 1, further comprising at least one securing member releasably coupling the first shell portion to the second shell portion in a closed configuration.
8. The container of claim 7 wherein the at least one securing member is configured for audible engagement.
9. The container of claim 1 wherein an interior face of at least one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion comprises a branding area.
10. A method of manufacturing a container, the method comprising: providing a mold shaped to define: a first shell portion; a second shell portion sized and shaped to complement the first shell portion to define a product cavity; a bridging portion coupled to the first shell portion at a first hinge and the second shell portion at a second hinge, wherein the bridging portion is pivotable relative to each of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in a disassembled configuration and the bridging portion is pivotable relative to only one of the first shell portion at the first hinge or the second shell portion at the second hinge in an assembled configuration; and a fastener coupled to the bridging portion and to one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion in the assembled configuration, wherein the fastener prevents the bridging portion from pivoting relative to the one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion in the assembled configuration; forming the container using the mold; and coupling

permanently the bridging portion to one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion.

11. The method of claim 10 wherein one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion is sized and shaped to house a product when the container is in an open configuration.

12. The method of claim 10 wherein each of the first shell portion and the second shell portion is sized and shaped to house a product when the container is in an open configuration.

13. The method of claim 10 wherein the mold is further shaped to define at least one stadium member shaped to stagger an arrangement of a plurality of articles in the container.

14. The method of claim 10 wherein the mold is further shaped to define at least one securing member releasably coupling the first shell portion to the second shell portion in a closed configuration.

15. The method of claim 14 wherein the at least one securing member is configured for audible engagement.

16. The method of claim 10, further comprising applying a branding area to an interior face of at least one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion.

17. The method of claim 10, further comprising filling at least one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion with a product comprising a plurality of articles.

18. A container comprising: a first shell portion; a second shell portion sized and shaped to complement the first shell portion to define a product cavity; a bridging portion coupled to the first shell portion at a first hinge and the second shell portion at a second hinge, wherein the bridging portion is pivotable relative to each of the first shell portion at the first hinge and the second shell portion at the second hinge in a disassembled configuration and the bridging portion is pivotable relative to one of the first shell portion at the first hinge or the second shell portion at the second hinge in an assembled configuration, wherein a distance between the first shell portion and the second shell portion is greater in the disassembled configuration than in the assembled configuration; and a fastener coupled to the bridging portion and to one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion in the assembled configuration, wherein the fastener prevents the bridging portion from pivoting relative to the one of the first shell portion or the second shell portion in the assembled configuration.

19. The container of claim 5 wherein each article of the plurality articles is secured by an article organizing member, wherein the plurality of articles are secured by an article stack organizing member.

20. The container of claim 19, wherein the article organizing member comprises a belly band, wherein the article stack organizing member comprises a sheath.
